Zayd Edrylson Sinsuat Tolentino

Zayd Edrylson Sinsuat Tolentino is a Filipino Muslim technology leader and digital transformation architect who has shaped the Philippine fintech, insurtech, and enterprise technology landscapes. A member of the Maguindanaoan-Maranao ethnic group through his mother's Sinsuat lineage, Tolentino has emerged as one of the country's youngest and most influential Chief Technology Officers, leading major digital initiatives across multiple industries. His career reflects a commitment to building scalable, purposeful technology that expands access, improves operational efficiency, and creates pathways for underrepresented communities in the Philippine tech ecosystem.

Tolentino's professional trajectory demonstrates a deliberate progression from hands-on engineering to strategic leadership. He began his career as an IT specialist and software engineer before emerging as one of the earliest architects of cloud-native solutions in the Philippines. His leadership at fintech pioneer Singlife Philippines, where he served as Chief Technology Officer at age 31, marked a turning point in his influence, positioning him as a thought leader in digital financial services. Previously, as Chief Technology Officer of Stratpoint Technologies, he led organizational transformation by strengthening internal capabilities across architecture, engineering, product, and security, while helping develop future technology leaders. Today, as Vice President of Technology at Pickup Coffee, he continues to drive transformation and advocate for greater representation of Muslim professionals in the Philippine technology sector.

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Early Life and Background

Zayd Edrylson Sinsuat Tolentino was raised in Cagayan de Oro, a growing commercial city in northern Mindanao. He comes from a Muslim family with deep roots in the region. His father is a Balik-Islam convert, while his mother belongs to the Maguindanaoan-Maranao ethnic group, tracing her lineage to the prominent Abbas-Sinsuat

clan, a name synonymous with Bangsamoro leadership and governance.

His introduction to technology began at approximately age seven, when his uncle gifted him his first computer and taught him basic DOS commands to run simple games. What started as youthful curiosity about operating systems evolved into genuine fascination with how systems worked and what made them function. This technical curiosity was complemented by an intuitive inclination toward building and problem-solving. Throughout his childhood, Tolentino spent considerable time assembling and experimenting with Legos and puzzles, activities that nurtured a natural tendency to construct, deconstruct, and understand complex systems.

This early combination of technical exposure and hands-on problem-solving became foundational to his later approach to software engineering and systems architecture. Rather than viewing technology as merely academic or abstract, he developed a pragmatic, builder-first mindset that would characterize his entire professional career.



Zayd Edrylson Sinsuat Tolentino	
Born	Quezon City
Ethnicity	Maguindanaoan-Maranao (Sinsuat lineage)
Religion	Islam
Education	Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Capitol University
Notable Positions	CTO, Singlife Philippines; CTO, Stratpoint Technologies; VP of Technology, Pickup Coffee
Known For	Digital transformation in fintech, insurtech, logistics; building Singlife Plan and Protect app
Advocacy	Expanding Muslim representation in Philippine tech; community technology education

Education

Tolentino earned his Bachelor of Science in Computer Science from Capitol University in Cagayan de Oro. His academic training provided the theoretical foundation and technical depth necessary for a career that would ultimately synthesize engineering rigor, architectural thinking, and strategic product vision.

Career

Early Technical Foundation

Tolentino began his professional journey in hands-on technical roles that exposed him to technology across multiple layers. He worked as an IT specialist, troubleshooting hardware, networks, and peripheral systems while simultaneously contributing to software development projects. During this period, he held roles as a technical analyst, graphic artist, software engineer, and SAP engineer, giving him exposure to both infrastructure-level work and enterprise business systems.

This deliberate range of early experience shaped a fundamental philosophy: that effective technology solutions must be grounded in real-world problems and operational constraints, not theoretical elegance alone. Understanding how systems actually failed and how end-users experienced technology became central to his design approach.

Cloud Architecture and Early Leadership

Tolentino became part of the pioneering wave of Philippine software engineers adopting and designing with cloud technologies such as Amazon Web Services and Microsoft Azure. During a period when cloud adoption in the country was still nascent, his work contributed to designing scalable, cloud-native architectures that enabled organizations to modernize legacy systems and operate more efficiently across distributed environments.

This expertise in cloud infrastructure and microservices architecture positioned him as a technical authority during a critical transformation phase in the Philippine technology industry.

Head of Systems Engineering at QuadX

At a relatively young age, Tolentino became Head of Systems Engineering at QuadX, a logistics and e-commerce technology company focused on addressing the Philippines' last-mile delivery challenges. In this role, he led the architecture and scaling of platforms that orchestrated logistics operations, managed fulfillment workflows, and coordinated delivery services across the country.

His work directly addressed critical inefficiencies in the Philippine logistics sector by building systems that improved delivery coordination, visibility, and operational scalability. The experience taught him how technology could solve infrastructure gaps while supporting rapid growth in digital commerce, a lesson he carried forward into subsequent leadership roles.

Chief Software Architect and Data Privacy Officer at Olelo

Following his tenure at QuadX, Tolentino took on dual responsibilities as Chief Software Architect and Data Privacy Officer at Olelo, an analytics company helping brands understand audience behavior and optimize communication strategies.

In this role, he designed systems enabling data-driven insights for brands, public figures, and organizations seeking to analyze social media engagement and audience dynamics. Simultaneously, he stewarded data privacy compliance, ensuring that innovative systems adhered to emerging standards and protected user information. This dual responsibility deepened his understanding of building technology that balanced innovation with accountability, a principle he would emphasize throughout his career.

Founder of Zest Technology

Tolentino founded Zest Technology, a consultancy through which he worked closely with startups and enterprises to design systems, launch digital products, and support digital transformation initiatives. The venture reflected his philosophy of bridging the gap between business strategy and technical execution.

Through Zest, he helped founders and organizations avoid unnecessary technical complexity while ensuring that architecture decisions remained aligned with business objectives. His focus was on sustainable, pragmatic solutions that could evolve as organizations scaled.

Chief Technology Officer at Singlife Philippines

Tolentino's most visible and impactful leadership role came when he became Chief Technology Officer of Singlife Philippines, a mobile-first digital life insurer disrupting the traditional insurance industry. He assumed this position at age 31, making him one of the youngest CTOs in the Philippine financial services sector at that time.

In this role, Tolentino built Singlife Philippines' entire digital platform from inception. He led the design and development of a fully integrated life insurance ecosystem that unified distribution, underwriting, policy management, and customer engagement into a single digital experience accessible via smartphone. The platform supported both B2B2C partnerships (notably through GCash and the Mynt ecosystem) and direct-to-consumer engagement through the Singlife Plan and Protect mobile application.

His technical leadership enabled multiple key innovations: dramatically simplified onboarding processes, automated underwriting workflows, and transparent customer experiences that demystified insurance for everyday Filipinos. The platform reached tens of thousands of customers in its first year and demonstrated that digital-first financial services could serve underserved populations excluded from traditional insurance channels.

> "This level of convenience coupled with affordability and reliability are what today's middle-class Filipinos are looking for in a life insurer, and what we aim to deliver."

Tolentino's work at Singlife became a case study in fintech innovation, demonstrating how strategic technology architecture could expand financial inclusion while maintaining operational efficiency and security.

Co-Founder and Chief Technology Officer at Workbean

During his fintech career, Tolentino also co-founded Workbean, a culture technology platform focused on organizational and talent matching based on work persona and company culture alignment. As Chief Technology Officer, he translated insights from leading teams and organizations into structured models and algorithms that power the platform.

Workbean reflected his conviction that technology could solve not only system-level technical challenges but also the human dimensions of organizational success. The platform addressed a persistent gap: the misalignment between talented individuals and organizational cultures, a problem that transcends traditional skills-based matching.

Chief Technology Officer at Stratpoint Technologies

In June 2024, Tolentino was appointed Chief Technology Officer of Stratpoint Technologies, a leading Philippine software and digital transformation company. In this role, he leads the organization's technology strategy and transformation, with responsibility for advanced technology development, solution delivery, and innovation.

A central focus of his tenure is developing Filipino technology talent to compete globally. He has introduced structured practices across architecture, engineering, product, and security, enabling the company to deliver higher-quality outcomes while strengthening internal capabilities. His leadership emphasizes that the Philippines' competitive advantage in technology rests on investing in people, processes, and long-term capability building.

Vice President of Technology at Pickup Coffee

Tolentino currently serves as Vice President of Technology at Pickup Coffee, the Philippines' fast-growing premium coffee franchise. He oversees product engineering, enterprise technology, Technology Delivery Management, Enterprise Solutions, Engineering and Security, Data, and IT Experience (ITX).

His mandate is establishing scalable, sustainable technology foundations that integrate operations, customer platforms, and data systems to improve efficiency and decision-making. This role demonstrates his versatility in applying digital transformation across industries beyond fintech, extending his impact to consumer-facing retail technology.

Advocacy, Values, and Community Impact

Beyond his corporate roles, Tolentino is committed to expanding the Philippine technology ecosystem and creating pathways for underrepresented communities. He is a co-founder of WeHackPH, a community initiative bringing together developers, product builders, and founders to collaborate, learn, and innovate collectively.

A project particularly close to his heart involves supporting technology education and exposure in Muslim communities. He has been involved in initiatives designed to introduce young students, particularly young women, to technology and career opportunities in software engineering. Through these efforts, he seeks to inspire more young Muslims, especially women, to pursue and advance in technology careers.

His advocacy is rooted in a conviction that technology sectors thrive when they include talent and perspectives from all communities. The underrepresentation of Muslim professionals in Philippine technology, despite the country's growing tech economy, is a gap he actively works to address through mentorship, visibility, and community engagement.

Vision and Legacy

Tolentino's long-term vision extends beyond corporate leadership to institutional transformation. He envisions establishing a fully digital Islamic bank in the Philippines, a project that would synthesize his fintech expertise, commitment to financial inclusion, and dedication to serving Muslim communities.

This vision exemplifies his broader philosophy: technology should be purposeful, grounded in solving real problems, and directed toward expanding access and opportunity for those currently underserved by existing systems.

His career trajectory represents a broader shift in the Philippine technology landscape, where builders from diverse ethnic, religious, and geographic backgrounds are shaping the future of digital systems and services. As a Filipino Muslim occupying senior technology leadership roles, Tolentino contributes to expanding visibility and creating role models for future generations of Muslim technologists.

Recognition and Industry Engagement

Tolentino has been featured in industry publications and podcasts discussing fintech innovation, technology leadership, and career development in Philippine technology. His insights on microservices architecture, cloud strategy, and building high-performing engineering teams have contributed to professional discourse around digital transformation.

His career demonstrates that technology leadership in the Philippines can be built not through imported frameworks alone, but through deep understanding of local problems, commitment to sustainable solutions, and deliberate investment in people and capability.

See Also

- List of Filipino Technology Entrepreneurs
- Digital Transformation in the Philippines
- Islamic Finance in Southeast Asia
- WeHackPH
- Singlife Philippines

Further Reading

- GMA News Online. "Singlife Philippines to launch direct-to-customer initiatives in Q3." February 21, 2021.
- Back End News. "Stratpoint Technologies welcomes Zayd Tolentino as new CTO." June 11, 2024.
- Solvecast. "Zayd Tolentino: Technology Evangelist Profile."

External Links

- Zayd Tolentino on LinkedIn (https://www.linkedin.com/in/zuperzayd)
- BangsamoroPedia (https://wiki.maranaw.com)

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